

The Loopital Handbook

How we think, how we work, and what it actually takes to build something that matters. A working guide for everyone building Loopital.

REACH BEYOND

LOOPITAL LIMITED · FIRST EDITION, 2026 · WRITTEN BY TUAMENE BESTGOD, CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER

FOREWORD

Read this like it belongs to you

Most company handbooks are written to protect the company. This one is written to make you dangerous.

Not dangerous in a reckless way. Dangerous in the way a person becomes when they genuinely understand the game they are playing, when they know why decisions get made the way they do, when they can spot a mistake forming before it costs anyone anything.

Here is the truth about where you have landed. Loopital is a startup. That word gets used loosely, so this handbook spends real time on what it actually means. But the short version is this: we are a small group of people trying to find something valuable that does not exist yet, before our time and money run out. Most groups who try this fail. The data is genuinely brutal, and you will read the real numbers in Chapter 4, not a softened version of them.

I am not telling you that to frighten you. I am telling you because the people who succeed in this work are the ones who understand the odds and choose to play anyway, with their eyes open. Those are the people I want building this company.

What you will find in here is not just Loopital's rules. It is the accumulated thinking of people who built Google, Netflix, Amazon, Airbnb, and Paystack, alongside the hard lessons from companies that burned through billions and still failed. It includes philosophy from Japan, from Southern Africa, and one framework we built ourselves. It covers how science, art, politics, and religion actually shape a company like ours, because pretending they do not is how companies get blindsided.

You should read this once now, properly, and then return to specific chapters as they become real to you. The chapter on equity will mean more once you have been here a year. The chapter on failure will mean more the first time something you built does not work.

One more thing. If you ever read something in here that you think is wrong, say so. A handbook nobody feels free to argue with is not a culture, it is decoration. We want the first kind.

Tuamene BestGod
Founder and Chief Executive Officer, Loopital Limited

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PART ONE

Who We Are

Before anything else, you should know what this company believes, why it exists at all, and what we are actually trying to build. Everything else in this handbook is downstream of these three chapters.

01 Our Mission, Vision, and Values

02 Why Loopital Exists: The Story Behind the Company

03 What We Build, and Who It Is For

CHAPTER ONE

Our Mission, Vision, and Values

Most companies write values that could belong to anyone. "Integrity. Excellence. Teamwork." Nobody disagrees, and nobody changes their behaviour because of them. Ours are written to be usable, which means they have to be specific enough that you could actually break one.

Our Mission

> **We build AI powered software for the institutions that hold everyday life together, hospitals, schools, facility operators, and growing businesses, so the people inside them spend less time fighting their systems and more time doing the work that matters.**

Read that carefully, because the second half is the part people skip. We are not in the business of building software. We are in the business of returning time and attention to people who are drowning in process. Software happens to be the tool. If a customer gets more value from a phone call than a feature, we make the phone call.

Our Vision

> **A world where great systems are not a privilege. Where a clinic in a small town runs on software as good as a hospital in a capital city, and where the place you were born does not decide the quality of care, education, or opportunity you get.**

This is deliberately larger than what we can currently deliver. A vision you can already achieve is not a vision, it is a task. The gap between this sentence and our current reality is the work.

Our Six Values, and How to Break Them

Each value below is written with its failure mode, because a value you cannot violate is not doing any work.

1. Warmth, before anything technical

We design for the person on the other end, not the dashboard. **You break this** when you optimise a number without asking who experiences the consequence, or when you describe users as "traffic" rather than as people having a day.

2. Honesty, especially when it costs us

We tell the truth about where we are. Every proposal we have sent to a ministry, every grant application, every investor conversation states plainly that most of our products are still in testing. **You break this** when you let someone believe we are further along than we are, including by staying silent while they assume it.

3. Proof before scale

We validate quietly with real users before we ask anyone to pay or make big claims. **You break this** when you push to launch something broadly because it feels ready, rather than because evidence says it is.

4. Craft over speed for its own sake

We would rather ship one thing beautifully than five adequately. **You break this** when you ship something you know is weak because a deadline felt more real than the user.

5. Ownership without waiting

If you see it, it is yours until you hand it to someone specific. **You break this** when you notice a problem outside your role and assume someone else will handle it.

6. Ambition without arrogance

We are trying to change how healthcare works in an entire region. We also know exactly how small we currently are. **You break this** in either direction, by thinking too small about what we could become, or by talking as though we have already become it.

Why values only matter when they cost something

In 2018, Netflix published one of the most influential documents in modern business, a culture deck that Sheryl Sandberg, then Facebook's Chief Operating Officer, called one of the most important documents ever to come out of Silicon Valley. It has been viewed more than twenty million times.

The deck's central argument was blunt: the values a company actually has are the behaviours it rewards and punishes, not the words on its wall. Netflix wrote that if a company claims integrity as a value but promotes people who take credit for others' work, then its real value is self promotion, whatever the poster says.

> **The test we use at Loopital:** a value is real if you can name a time it cost us something. If honesty has never lost us a deal, we are probably not being honest in the moments where it would be expensive. If proof before scale has never delayed a launch we were excited about, we are probably not actually practising it.

Where our values come from

These six did not come from a branding session. They came from decisions we already made under pressure, before we had words for them.

- **Honesty** came from writing "currently in internal testing, zero external users" into a funding application where we could have written something vaguer and probably scored better.
- **Proof before scale** came from choosing to run free hospital pilots rather than charging early, even though revenue would have made every conversation with investors easier.
- **Warmth** came from the founding story you will read in the next chapter, which is not a marketing story. It is a hospital story.

> **What to do with this chapter:** when you face a decision this handbook does not specifically cover, run it against these six. If a choice requires breaking one, that is not automatically wrong, but it should be a conscious trade you can defend out loud, not something that happens quietly.

CHAPTER TWO

Why Loopital Exists

Every company has an origin story it tells investors. This is the one that is actually true, and it did not happen in an office.

Our founder's mother had a medical emergency. She was unconscious for four days. Over those days, she was moved between three different hospitals, and at every single one, the people treating her started from nothing. New doctors. No records. No knowledge of what had already been tried, ruled out, or reacted badly to. The family stood in each new hospital trying to remember and explain a medical history from memory, while the person who could have explained it herself could not speak.

There were queues at every stop. Other families in exactly the same position, waiting, explaining, waiting again.

She survived. Many people in that same situation do not, and they do not die because Nigeria lacks good doctors. They die in the gap between arriving and being understood.

> **That gap is the entire reason this company exists.** Not a market opportunity spotted in a report. A specific, frightening, personal experience that made it impossible to stop noticing how many people go through the same thing every single day.

From one experience to a pattern

Once you see a problem clearly in one place, you start seeing its shape everywhere. A hospital that cannot remember a patient. A school still running admissions on paper while every parent has a phone. A facility manager who finds out a generator failed only after it has already cost money. A small business owner using six different tools before their first coffee.

Different sectors, same underlying failure: institutions that cannot hold their own context, so the humans inside them carry it manually, at enormous cost, every single day.

Why this matters for how you work

Founding stories are not decoration. They set the standard for what "good enough" means. When you are deciding whether a feature is finished, whether an interface is clear enough, whether a bug is worth fixing before launch, the question is not whether it passes a checklist. It is whether it would have helped in that hospital, on that fourth day.

> **A note on emotional honesty:** we do not use this story to manipulate anyone. It appears in our fundraising materials because it is the actual reason we exist, told plainly. If you ever find yourself dramatising it to win something, stop. The story is powerful because it is true, and it stops being powerful the moment it becomes a performance.

CHAPTER THREE

What We Build, and Who It Is For

Five products, four sectors, one underlying belief: institutions should be able to remember, coordinate, and act without the humans inside them doing it all by hand.

Henholib

A health identity that follows a patient to any hospital on the network. For patients, especially in emergencies.

STATUS: BUILT, INTERNAL TESTING

HMS7

The hospital side of Henholib. Records, triage, prescriptions, billing, in one system. For hospitals and clinics.

STATUS: BUILT, INTERNAL TESTING

Modus

Facility, asset, and maintenance management. For organisations running buildings and sites.

STATUS: LIVE, REAL CLIENTS TESTING

Pal Workspace

An AI team member with its own workspace. Handles busywork, joins meetings, manages social presence.

STATUS: BUILT, INTERNAL TESTING

Beacon

School admissions, records, and administration in one place. For schools still running on paper.

STATUS: BUILT, INTERNAL TESTING

Why five products and not one

This is a fair question, and one investors ask us. Conventional startup advice says focus on one thing. There are two honest answers.

The first is that these products share a spine. Henholib and HMS7 are two halves of one system. Modus, Beacon, and Pal all solve the same class of problem, an institution or person losing track of what is happening across their own operation. The engineering patterns, the data models, and the sales conversations rhyme.

The second answer is more honest: this is a real risk. Splitting attention across five products at pre seed stage is exactly the kind of thing that kills companies, and Chapter 5 covers "lack of focus" as a documented cause of startup failure. Our response is not to pretend the risk is not there. It is to be clear about hierarchy.

> **The hierarchy, so nobody is confused:** Henholib and HMS7 are the flagship. They carry the mission, the fundraising story, and the government conversations. Modus is our proof of execution, it is live, with real clients. Pal and Beacon are real products with real potential, but they do not get to slow the flagship down.

Who we actually serve

- **Patients and families**, especially those arriving at a hospital where nobody knows them, in an emergency, or managing an ongoing condition across multiple facilities.
- **Hospitals and clinics**, particularly small and mid sized private facilities still running on paper, where a single system replaces a filing cabinet and a lot of memory.
- **Facility and operations teams** managing multiple sites, who currently find out about problems after they have already cost money.
- **Schools** doing admissions and records by hand, where administrative time is being taken directly from teaching time.
- **Small businesses and solo professionals** juggling too many disconnected tools to do their actual work.

Where this goes

We prove the model in Nigeria first, because we understand it best and because the need is most acute here. Then across Africa, where the same institutional gaps exist in different shapes. The long term goal is not to be a Nigerian company that stayed small. It is to be a company from here that built something the rest of the world eventually adopts.

That is what Reach Beyond actually means. Not a slogan about ambition in general. A specific intention to go further than the ceiling people assume applies to companies that start where we started.

PART TWO

Understanding the Game

Most people join a startup without ever being told how one actually works, how the money moves, why most of them die, or what their own stake is really worth. That is a failure of the companies, not the people. These four chapters fix it.

04 What a Startup Actually Is

05 Why Startups Fail, and What That Teaches Us

06 Money: Funding Stages, Valuation, and Runway

07 Your Stake: Salary, Equity, and Vesting

CHAPTER FOUR

What a Startup Actually Is

A startup is not a small company. A small company is a smaller version of something that already works. A startup is a temporary organisation searching for something that does not exist yet.

That word, temporary, is the part most people miss. A startup is not supposed to stay a startup. It is supposed to either find a repeatable, profitable way of operating and become a real company, or discover that no such thing exists and stop honestly. Both outcomes are legitimate. Staying a startup forever, permanently searching and never finding, is the failure mode nobody names.

The three questions every startup is really answering

- **Is this a real problem?** Not interesting, not technically impressive, but painful enough that someone will change their behaviour to solve it.
- **Can we solve it in a way people will actually adopt?** Being right about the solution is not enough if using it requires people to change more than they are willing to.
- **Can we reach those people repeatably, at a cost lower than what they pay us?** This is the question that separates a good idea from a business.

Everything you do at Loopital is ultimately in service of answering one of those three. If you cannot connect your work to one of them, that is worth raising.

Where Loopital sits right now



We are pre seed. Modus is live with real client facilities. Swift's integration with Meta's advertising platform runs in production. Henholib, HMS7, Pal Workspace, and Beacon are built and functional but not yet in real users' hands. That is the honest picture, and it is the same picture we give investors, ministries, and grant committees.

> **Say this correctly in public.** If someone asks what Loopital is, the accurate answer is: "We are an early stage Nigerian software company. One of our products is live with real clients, the rest are built and moving into pilots." Not "we are launching soon," not "we have thousands of users." Overstating our stage is the single fastest way to lose credibility with the exact people whose trust we need most.

CHAPTER FIVE

Why Startups Fail

You cannot avoid a failure mode you have never heard of. This chapter is the most useful one in the handbook, and the least comfortable.

Start with the real numbers, not the myth. The often repeated claim that ninety percent of startups fail is not well supported. United States Bureau of Labor Statistics data suggests roughly forty eight percent fail within five years. That is still close to a coin flip, and it is the honest figure.

More useful is why. CB Insights, a research firm, has analysed hundreds of startup post mortems, essays founders wrote about why their own company died. Their updated analysis of 431 venture backed failures found the following pattern.



Source: CB Insights analysis of 431 venture backed startup failures. Categories overlap, so percentages exceed 100.

The most important detail in this data: "ran out of capital" appears in around seventy percent of failures, but CB Insights explicitly calls it the final cause, not the root cause. Companies rarely die because money ran out. They die because they spent the money chasing demand that was never really there, and the money running out is simply when that became undeniable.

Four failures worth studying properly

These are not amusing anecdotes. Each one demonstrates a failure mode we are personally exposed to.

RAISED $1.75 BILLION · DEAD IN SIX MONTHS

Quibi: building for a behaviour that did not exist

Quibi was a short form video streaming service founded by Jeffrey Katzenberg, a Hollywood executive, and Meg Whitman, formerly chief executive of eBay and Hewlett Packard. Two of the most experienced operators available. They raised 1.75 billion dollars and launched in April 2020.

They shut down in December of the same year. The product asked people to pay for short videos on mobile, at a moment when YouTube and TikTok already offered similar content for free, and when a pandemic had people at home wanting longer content, not shorter. Katzenberg and Whitman's own statement said the idea may not have been strong enough to justify a standalone service, or the timing was wrong, and that it was probably both.

Lesson for us: enormous funding and experienced leadership cannot manufacture a behaviour that people do not already want. Before we build a feature, the question is not "would this be good" but "what is the user doing today instead, and is that painful enough to change."

RAISED ~$700 MILLION · CRIMINAL CONVICTION

Theranos: what happens when the story outruns the truth

Theranos claimed it could run comprehensive blood tests from a single finger prick. Founder Elizabeth Holmes raised over 700 million dollars at a peak valuation around 9 billion. The technology never worked reliably. Rather than admit that, the company concealed it, used commercial machines while claiming its own, and pressured internal dissenters into silence. Real patients received inaccurate results. Holmes was ultimately convicted of fraud and sentenced to prison.

Lesson for us: we are also a health technology company, which means this is our nearest cautionary tale, not a distant one. The pressure to overstate is real and it comes gradually. It starts with rounding up a number in a pitch. Our defence is Chapter 1's honesty value, applied specifically when it is expensive.

RAISED ~$120 MILLION · SHUT DOWN IN TWO YEARS

Juicero: solving a problem that was not there

Juicero built an internet connected juice press that sold for several hundred dollars and used proprietary juice packs. It raised around 120 million dollars from serious investors. Then Bloomberg journalists demonstrated that you could squeeze the packs by hand, in about the same time, with the same result. The machine was unnecessary. The company became a punchline and closed shortly after.

Lesson for us: sophisticated technology applied to a problem that a simpler method already solves is not innovation, it is waste. Before adding complexity to any Loopital product, ask what the user does today and whether our version is genuinely better, not just more advanced.

VALUATION FELL FROM ~$47 BILLION

WeWork: growth without economics underneath it

WeWork rented buildings on long leases and sublet them on short flexible terms, describing itself as a technology company. Backed heavily by SoftBank, it reached a private valuation near 47 billion dollars. When it filed to go public, the financials became visible: enormous losses, a real estate cost structure wearing technology company clothing, and governance problems around founder Adam Neumann. The offering collapsed, Neumann resigned, and the valuation fell to single digit billions.

Lesson for us: growth that costs more than it earns is not growth, it is a countdown. When we eventually price HMS7 or Modus subscriptions, the unit economics have to work at small scale, not "once we are big enough."

The premature scaling trap

The Startup Genome Project found that around seventy four percent of high growth internet startups fail from premature scaling, growing headcount, spending, or market coverage before the underlying model is proven. Their research also found that ninety three percent of startups that scale prematurely never pass one hundred thousand dollars in monthly revenue.

This is the failure mode most relevant to a company running five products at once. Our defence is the hierarchy in Chapter 3 and the proof before scale value in Chapter 1. Both exist specifically because of this data.

How to use this chapter in your actual work. When you propose something, be able to answer: which failure mode does this expose us to, and what would tell us early that it is happening? A team that can name its own risks is far harder to kill than one that only talks about upside.

Failure is data, not identity

None of this is meant to make anyone afraid to try things. The point is the opposite. Understanding how companies die lets you take bigger, better informed risks, because you know which ones actually matter. An experiment that fails cheaply and teaches you something is a good outcome. Chapter 10 covers exactly how we treat failure without punishment while still holding real accountability.

CHAPTER SIX

Money: Funding, Valuation, and Runway

You cannot make good decisions inside a company whose finances you do not understand. This chapter explains how startup money actually works, in plain terms.

The funding stages

- **Bootstrapping.** The founders fund it themselves. No outside investor, no dilution, complete control, very limited resources. This is where Loopital is today.
- **Pre seed.** The first small outside money, often from angels, family, or early believers, used to build a first product and gather initial proof. Typically tens to low hundreds of thousands of dollars.
- **Seed.** The first substantial institutional round, once there is a working product and early evidence people want it. Used to find a repeatable way to acquire customers.
- **Series A.** Larger money once a company has proven it can acquire customers repeatably and profitably. Used to pour fuel on an engine that already runs.
- **Series B and onward.** Scale capital. New markets, aggressive hiring, defending market position.

What a valuation actually is

A valuation is not a measurement of a company's worth in any objective sense. It is the price a specific investor agreed to pay for a specific slice, at a specific moment, based on how much risk they believe remains.

If an investor pays 200,000 dollars for ten percent of a company, that implies a two million dollar valuation. That number is not a fact about the company. It is a fact about a negotiation.

> **Why valuations rise, and why this matters to you.** Valuation is inversely related to remaining risk. A company with an idea and no product is almost entirely risk. A company with paying customers, proven retention, and predictable growth has retired most of it. Every real hospital that adopts HMS7, every client Modus keeps, every honest proof point this team produces, removes risk. Removing risk is what raises valuation.

Dilution, explained without fear

When a company issues new shares to investors, everyone's percentage of ownership decreases. This is called dilution, and new people often find it alarming. It should not be, if it is done well.

Owning one hundred percent of a company worth nothing is worth nothing. Owning seventy percent of a company worth ten million dollars is worth seven million. The question is never "did my percentage go down." It is "did the value created by that money exceed the percentage given up." Good rounds make everyone's smaller slice worth more than their larger slice used to be.

Runway and burn

Burn rate is how much money a company spends per month beyond what it earns. **Runway** is how many months of survival that leaves. If a company has 60,000 dollars and burns 10,000 per month, it has six months of runway.

Runway is the single most important number in an early stage company, because it converts everything abstract into a deadline. It is why we do not hire ahead of proof, and why proof before scale is a value rather than a preference.

> **What this means for your daily decisions.** Every subscription we do not need, every tool we buy without using, every week spent building something nobody validated, is runway spent. You do not need to be frugal about everything. You need to know that spending is always spending time, not just money.

CHAPTER SEVEN

Your Stake: Salary, Equity, and Vesting

Most people join early stage companies without ever having equity properly explained to them. That is unfair, and it leads to both disappointment and unrealistic expectation. Here is the honest version.

Salary at this stage

Loopital is currently self funded. Salaries today reflect the actual financial reality of a company that has not raised outside investment, not the market rate we intend to pay once we have. We will not pretend otherwise, and you should not accept a company that does.

As pilots convert, revenue arrives, and funding is raised, compensation moves toward market rate. That progression will be tied to the company's real financial position at each stage, communicated openly, not held out as a vague promise.

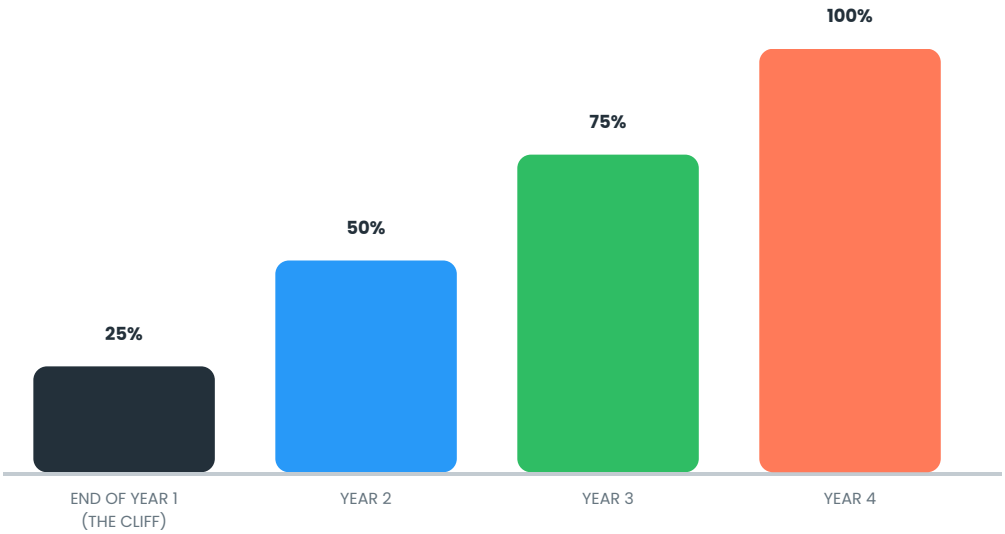
What equity actually is

Equity means owning a legal share of the company itself. Not a bonus. Not a gift. An actual ownership stake that rises and falls with the company's value.

It is important to be clear eyed here. Equity in an early stage startup is genuinely valuable and genuinely uncertain at the same time. If Loopital succeeds, it can be worth many times more than any salary difference. If Loopital fails, it is worth nothing. That is the trade, and it should be made with open eyes.

Vesting, and the one year cliff

Vesting means you earn equity gradually rather than owning it all on day one. The industry standard, which we follow, is four year vesting with a one year cliff.



The cliff means nothing vests until you complete one full year. Leave in month eleven and you receive nothing. Pass the one year mark and twenty five percent vests at once, with the remainder vesting steadily, usually monthly, across the following three years.

> **Why cliffs exist, stated plainly.** They protect the company and everyone in it from someone joining, receiving ownership, and leaving after a few months. It is a fairness mechanism for the people who stay, not a trap for people who go.

Questions you should ask, and should always get answered

Anyone offered equity anywhere, at Loopital or elsewhere, should be able to ask these without discomfort:

- How many shares am I receiving, and how many total shares exist? A number of shares alone is meaningless without the denominator.
- What is the current valuation the company is using?
- What is my vesting schedule and cliff?
- What happens to my vested equity if I leave, or if the company is acquired?

If any company ever avoids answering these, that is information about the company.

The honest emotional reality of startup equity

Most startup equity ends up worth nothing, because most startups do not reach a large exit. That is simply true, and anyone who tells you otherwise is selling something.

What makes it worth taking anyway is that the upside is not proportional. A salary difference of some percent is linear. Equity in a company that succeeds is not. People who joined Paystack early, before Stripe acquired it in a deal reported above 200 million dollars, did not receive a modest bonus. They participated in an outcome that changed their financial position entirely.

> **The right way to hold this.** Treat your salary as what you are paid for your work, and your equity as a serious, well informed bet you have chosen to place on this specific team. Do not join a startup only for equity, and do not dismiss equity as imaginary. Both are mistakes in opposite directions.

How this connects to your daily work

This is the part that makes Chapter 6 concrete. Valuation rises as risk falls. Risk falls when we produce real proof. Real proof comes from a hospital successfully onboarded, a client retained, a bug caught before a customer saw it, a pilot that produced a measurable result.

Your work and your equity are not two separate conversations. They are the same conversation, viewed from two ends.

PART THREE

How We Think

Frameworks are not decoration. They are what let a small team make consistent decisions without needing permission for every one. These four chapters give you the mental tools we actually use, where they came from, and where they stop working.

08 The Silicon Valley Playbook, and Its Limits

09 Our Operating Philosophies

10 Tetrism: The Philosophy We Built

11 The World Around Us: Science, Art, Politics, and Belief

CHAPTER EIGHT

The Silicon Valley Playbook

A small region of California produced most of the operating ideas that modern technology companies run on. Some of them are genuinely excellent. Some of them are cultural artifacts that do not transfer. You should know which is which.

The ideas worth taking

Build, measure, learn

Eric Ries popularised this loop in *The Lean Startup*. Instead of building a complete product then discovering nobody wants it, you build the smallest thing that tests your riskiest assumption, measure what real people actually do with it, and learn whether to continue or change direction. Our free hospital pilots are exactly this loop, applied to healthcare.

The minimum viable product

An MVP is not a bad version of your product. It is the smallest thing that produces real learning. The distinction matters. A rough interface that teaches you whether hospitals will actually change their intake process is a good MVP. A polished feature nobody asked for is not, however finished it looks.

Do things that do not scale

Paul Graham, co founder of Y Combinator, argued that early stage companies should deliberately do unscalable things: personally onboarding every user, manually doing what software will eventually do, going to customers physically. Airbnb's founders famously travelled to New York to photograph hosts' apartments themselves. It did not scale. It taught them what the product needed to become.

Talent density over process

Netflix's culture deck argued that most company rules exist to handle the small percentage of people who behave badly, and that the cost is paid by everyone else. Their alternative was to raise talent density so high that freedom becomes safe, replacing rules with context and judgement. Reed Hastings and Patty McCord built the company around it.

Context, not control

Related, and more immediately useful to us. Rather than telling people what to do, leaders share the full context, the constraints, the reasoning, the goal, and let people make their own calls. It produces better decisions and it scales in a way instruction never does.

The ideas we deliberately reject

Copying Silicon Valley uncritically is its own failure mode. Several famous ideas are either wrong, or wrong for us.

"Move fast and break things"

Facebook's early motto, later abandoned by Facebook itself. It works when breaking things means a broken feature. We handle patient health information. When we break something, a hospital cannot see a patient's allergies. We move fast in how we learn and decide. We do not move fast in how we ship things that touch someone's health.

Growth at any cost

The WeWork lesson from Chapter 5. Growth that is not underpinned by working economics is a countdown, not a strategy. We would rather have twenty hospitals that stay than two hundred that leave.

The keeper test, as literally practised

Netflix's keeper test asks managers whether they would fight to keep each person, and treats a no as grounds for exit with severance. It genuinely produces high performance. It has also been widely criticised for creating an environment where people feel they are permanently auditioning, which can drive anxiety and burnout rather than excellence.

We take the useful half. We believe in high standards and honest performance conversations. We reject the version that leaves people afraid, because fear makes people hide problems, and hiding problems is fatal in a company handling health data.

> **The general principle for borrowing ideas.** Ask what problem the idea was invented to solve, and whether we actually have that problem. Netflix invented the keeper test to maintain talent density in a company of thousands. We are ten people who all know each other. The problem it solves is not currently our problem.

What Silicon Valley cannot give us

Most of that playbook assumes cheap capital, deep talent pools, mature legal infrastructure, and customers who already trust software. We operate where power is unreliable, where institutional trust must be earned slowly, where regulation is still forming, and where a hospital administrator has good reason to be skeptical of a young company promising to modernise their records.

That is not a disadvantage to apologise for. It is context that produces different, sometimes better, answers. Paystack did not succeed by copying Stripe. It succeeded by solving a Nigerian payments problem that global companies had ignored, well enough that Stripe eventually bought it.

CHAPTER NINE

Our Operating Philosophies

Four ideas from outside the technology world that shape how we build. Each is followed by what it actually looks like in a working week, because a philosophy you cannot apply on a Tuesday is not a philosophy, it is a quotation.

Kaizen: improvement as a habit, not an event

Kaizen is a Japanese term meaning change for better. It became central to Toyota's production system in the decades after the Second World War, and it carries a specific claim: that continuous small improvements, made by everyone rather than by a specialist department, outperform occasional large transformations.

The reasoning is compounding. A process improved by one percent weekly is transformed within a year, without a single dramatic intervention. It also changes who is allowed to improve things. Under Kaizen, the person doing the work is the person best placed to improve it, which means improvement is everyone's job, including yours, from your first week.



Then the cycle repeats, each pass a little better informed than the last.

> **On a Tuesday, this looks like:** noticing that the same question comes up in every customer onboarding call, and writing a short answer document instead of answering it fresh each time. Nobody assigned that. Kaizen says it is yours to do.

Wabi Sabi: the discipline of shipping the unfinished

Wabi Sabi is a Japanese aesthetic that finds beauty in things that are imperfect, impermanent, and incomplete. A hand thrown bowl with a visible irregularity is valued precisely because it shows its making.

Applied to product work, it is a defence against a specific failure: the endless polish that keeps something from ever reaching a user. A pilot with rough edges that teaches you something real is worth more than a perfect version that shipped three months later. It is also permission to be honest about our stage rather than hiding it behind polish we have not earned.

> **The important boundary.** Wabi Sabi is about accepting visible imperfection, not about accepting things that do not work. A rough interface is Wabi Sabi. A prescription feature that miscalculates a dose is not imperfection, it is a defect. Know the difference.

Yin and Yang: holding two true things at once



From Chinese philosophy, Yin and Yang describes forces that appear opposed but are actually interdependent. Neither is complete alone, and each contains a seed of the other, which is why the symbol places a dot of each colour inside its opposite.

This is directly useful because most bad decisions in a company come from treating a tension as a problem to eliminate rather than a balance to hold. Speed and care are not enemies. Ambition and honesty about our stage are not contradictory. Structure and autonomy need each other.

The practical instruction is this: when you notice yourself arguing for one side of a tension, check whether the other side is genuinely wrong, or simply inconvenient right now. Most of the time it is the second, and the right answer is a balance you can name rather than a victory.

Ubuntu: I am because we are

Ubuntu is a Southern African philosophy, articulated in the Nguni phrase "umuntu ngumuntu ngabantu", a person is a person through other people. It holds that individual humanity is realised through relationship and community rather than in isolation.

It sits close to home, and it is a deliberate counterweight to the individualist streak in Silicon Valley thinking, where the lone brilliant founder is the dominant myth. In a ten person company, that myth is not just inaccurate, it is dangerous. Nobody here succeeds alone, and nobody's win is separable from the team's.

> **On a Tuesday, this looks like:** finishing your own task and then asking who is blocked before picking up the next one. Under Ubuntu, a team member stuck at 6pm is not their problem, it is our problem.

Ikigai: the overlap worth finding

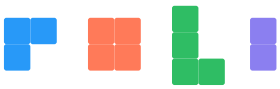
Ikigai is a Japanese concept usually translated as a reason for being. In its popular framing it sits at the intersection of what you love, what you are good at, what the world needs, and what you can be paid for.

We raise it not as a wellness idea but a practical one. People working from genuine purpose sustain difficult work far longer than people working from obligation, and early stage company work is difficult. Not every task will feel like Ikigai. But if your role never touches that overlap, that is worth a conversation rather than quiet endurance.

CHAPTER TEN

Tetrism: The Philosophy We Built

Every philosophy in the previous chapter came from somewhere else. This one is ours. It was developed at Loopital, it is named for Tetris, and Tetris is our company game for exactly this reason.



In Tetris, you never choose which piece falls next. You only ever choose what you do with the one that arrives. That single asymmetry, no control over the pieces, total control over the placement, is the whole philosophy.

It matters because most workplace anxiety comes from confusing the two. People punish themselves for pieces they did not choose, and they underestimate how much placement was genuinely theirs. Tetrism separates them deliberately.

In the workplace

- **Decisions are judged by what was knowable at the time.** Not by what emerged afterward. This removes the incentive to hide a reasonable call that did not pan out, which is the behaviour that actually damages companies.
- **Changing strategy is not institutional failure.** A team pivots the way a Tetrist abandons a bad personal move, without self punishment. The move is over. The next piece is already falling.
- **Wins count the moment they land**, even though the workload immediately fills back up. Teams that never pause to register a cleared line burn out measurably faster than teams that do.
- **Accountability still applies in full.** "We did our best with what we knew" is for judging your own reasonable mistakes. It is never a shield for avoiding responsibility for harm done to others.

> **The most misused part of this philosophy.** Tetrism forgives decisions, not consequences. If something we shipped harms a customer, the fact that the decision was reasonable at the time does not remove our obligation to repair it, quickly and at our own cost. Judge the decision fairly. Fix the harm completely. These are separate duties.

In innovation

- **Innovation lives in the placement, not the pieces.** You do not control which technology, market shift, or constraint arrives next. You control what you build in response.
- **Fast moving, unpredictable forces get met with neither optimism nor fear.** Artificial intelligence is the clearest current example. The Tetrist response is neither "this changes everything" nor "this threatens us", it is the best available placement given current information, revised as better information arrives.
- **Regret is replaced by remediation.** Failed experiments get logged as data and moved past quickly, rather than treated as reasons to freeze.

In positive social impact

- A Tetrist institution carries less blame culture and more repair, because decisions are judged against what was knowable rather than against hindsight.
- It resists both fatalism, the belief that nothing can be done, and utopianism, the belief that a final answer has been found. It favours adaptive, accountable structures instead.
- It draws a hard line between acceptance and injustice. Chance and timing get accepted. Wrongs done by people or systems get identified and acted on, at the right time, regardless of what form they take.
- Collective good is pursued through shared, adjustable targets rather than passive hope, which suits large coordination problems like public health far better than waiting for certainty ever could.

> **Why Tetris is our company game.** Every falling piece stands in for something we did not choose: a competitor's launch, a regulation, a customer changing their mind, a technology shift. The game teaches the exact reflex we want, which is to stop arguing with the piece and start thinking about placement. We also mean for you to actually play it sometimes.

How to use Tetrism in a real conversation

When something goes wrong, the Tetrist question is not "who should have known better." It is three questions in order: What was knowable at the time? Was the placement reasonable given that? What do we repair now, and what do we do differently with the next piece?

That sequence protects honesty, preserves accountability, and gets to a fix faster than blame ever does.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

The World Around Us

Companies that treat themselves as separate from science, art, politics, and belief get blindsided by all four. Here is how each one genuinely touches what we do.

Science: the standard of evidence we hold ourselves to

Science is not a subject here, it is a method, and it is the one our entire approach borrows from. A hypothesis, a test designed so it could actually fail, honest observation of the result, and a conclusion revised in the face of evidence.

This is precisely what a startup does when it works properly. "Hospitals will adopt HMS7 if onboarding takes under a day" is a hypothesis. A pilot is the experiment. The failure mode, in science and in startups alike, is deciding the answer first and then looking for support.

We also build in a health context, which means real clinical evidence matters. When Henholib touches anything with medical consequence, our standard is not what seems reasonable to us. It is what the evidence supports and what qualified people confirm.

Art: why design is not decoration

Apple's influence on technology came substantially from treating design as fundamental rather than cosmetic. Steve Jobs studied calligraphy after dropping out of formal classes at Reed College, and later credited that experience for the typography that shaped the Macintosh. An artistic detour became a defining commercial advantage.

For us, art matters in a specific and practical way. A nurse using HMS7 during a difficult shift is not evaluating our architecture. They are experiencing whether the screen makes sense under pressure. Clarity, rhythm, restraint, and visual hierarchy are what make software feel calm instead of hostile, and calm is a clinical benefit, not a preference.

> **The working principle:** if a person has to think about how to use our product, that thinking is being taken from the work they were actually doing. In a hospital, that is not a small cost.

Politics and regulation: the terrain we operate on

We are not a political company, and we do not take political positions. But politics is not optional context for us, it is operating terrain.

Health data in Nigeria falls under the Nigeria Data Protection Act. Payments fall under Central Bank regulation. Working with public hospitals means engaging with health ministries and agencies whose priorities shift with administrations. Any of these can accelerate us or stop us entirely.

There is also institutional politics, which is subtler and just as real. Introducing a new system into a hospital changes who holds information, who is accountable, and whose established way of working gets disrupted. Someone in that building may have good reason to resist us that has nothing to do with our software being good.

> **How we handle this.** Compliance is treated as a moat rather than a chore, which is one of our five strategic commitments. We do the regulatory groundwork early, we build relationships patiently, and we never assume a technically superior product wins automatically. It does not. Trust wins, and trust is political as much as technical.

Belief: working respectfully in a religious society

Nigeria is a deeply religious country, across multiple faiths, and this affects our work in concrete ways.

Health decisions are often made in consultation with family and faith communities, not individually. Attitudes to certain treatments, to end of life care, and to how medical information is shared can be shaped by religious conviction. A product that assumes a purely individualistic, secular decision maker will misread its own users.

Internally, our team holds different beliefs, and some hold none. The standard is straightforward: we respect all of it, we accommodate practice where we reasonably can, and we neither promote nor dismiss anyone's faith in a work setting. Nobody should feel they must hide their beliefs, and nobody should feel subjected to someone else's.

> **The unifying idea across all four.** A company that only understands its own technology is fragile. Science tells us how to know things. Art tells us how people experience them. Politics tells us what is permitted and by whom. Belief tells us what people actually value. Ignore any one of them and you will eventually be surprised by something that was entirely predictable.

PART FOUR

How We Work

This is the operational part. How work moves, how we decide, how we think through problems, and why everyone at this company, regardless of title, is part of how we win customers.

12 Scrum: How Work Actually Moves Here

13 Thinking Tools: SWOT and the Conjoined Triangle

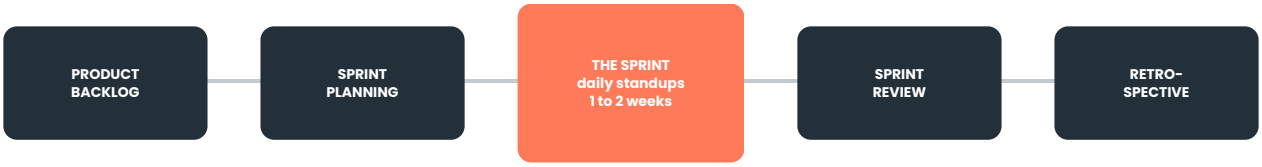
14 Everyone Is in Marketing and Sales

15 Customers: How We Earn and Keep Them

CHAPTER TWELVE

Scrum: How Work Actually Moves

Scrum organises work into short cycles called sprints, usually one to two weeks. It exists because detailed long term plans in an uncertain environment are almost always wrong, and discovering that after six months is expensive.



The retrospective feeds directly back into the backlog. That loop is the entire point.

The five parts, and what actually happens in each

The product backlog

Everything we could build, ordered by priority. Not a wish list, an ordered queue. The discipline is the ordering: if everything is high priority, nothing is, and the team will default to whatever is loudest rather than whatever matters.

Sprint planning

At the start of each cycle, the team decides together what can realistically be finished. The word finished is doing heavy lifting. A task is finished when it is tested, reviewed, and could go to a real user, not when the code is written.

The most common failure here is over commitment. Pulling in more than the team can complete feels ambitious and produces the opposite of ambition: a sprint that ends with several half finished things, none of which can be used or learned from.

Daily standups

A short daily check, ideally fifteen minutes, standing. Three questions each: what did I finish since yesterday, what am I doing today, what is blocking me.

Standups are not status reports to a manager. They are coordination between peers. If a standup consistently runs long, it has usually turned into a meeting, and the fix is to take the discussion offline with the two or three people it actually concerns.

> **The most valuable thirty seconds of your week** is naming a blocker in standup on the day it appears rather than the day before the deadline. Nobody at Loopital is judged for being blocked. People are judged for being blocked silently.

Sprint review

At the end of the cycle, the team demonstrates working results. Not slides describing progress, the actual thing, running. This is deliberately uncomfortable and deliberately honest. It also includes what did not get done and why, stated plainly.

Retrospective

Separate from the review, and about the team rather than the product. What went well, what did not, and what specifically will change next sprint. One concrete change is worth more than five vague intentions.

Retrospectives only work under psychological safety, which is a term from research led by Amy Edmondson at Harvard Business School: the shared belief that you will not be punished for speaking up. Google's own internal study of what made teams effective, known as Project Aristotle, found psychological safety to be the single most important factor, ahead of individual talent. If people cannot say what went wrong here, the meeting is theatre.

Roles in Scrum

- **Product owner**, who owns the backlog and its priority order, and answers what and why.
- **Scrum master**, who protects the process, removes blockers, and keeps the team from being pulled in ten directions mid sprint.
- **The team**, who decide how the work gets done. Not assigned individually by a manager, taken collectively.

At our size, people hold more than one of these. That is fine. What is not fine is nobody holding them, which is how a sprint quietly becomes a to do list.

Where Scrum fails

Scrum breaks in predictable ways, and you should be able to spot them: ceremonies performed without their purpose, sprints interrupted constantly by new requests, "done" quietly redefined to mean "mostly done", and retrospectives where nothing ever changes.

> **The underlying principle, if you forget everything else.** Short cycles, real working output, honest review, and one improvement each time. That is Kaizen from Chapter 9 applied to how we build. Same idea, different name.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

Thinking Tools

Two frameworks we use before committing to anything significant. Both take under an hour and both prevent expensive mistakes.

SWOT: seeing the whole picture before deciding

SWOT sorts a situation into four boxes. Strengths and Weaknesses are internal, things about us. Opportunities and Threats are external, things about the world. The value is in forcing all four, especially the two people naturally avoid.

STRENGTHS

Internal, positive

Small and fast. Deep market understanding. Modus live with real clients. Working products already built.

WEAKNESSES

Internal, negative

Pre revenue. Limited runway. Five products splitting attention. No large enterprise track record yet.

OPPORTUNITIES

External, positive

Most Nigerian hospitals still on paper. Government digital health priorities. AI tools lowering build cost.

THREATS

External, negative

Better funded competitors. Regulatory change. Institutional resistance. Long procurement cycles.

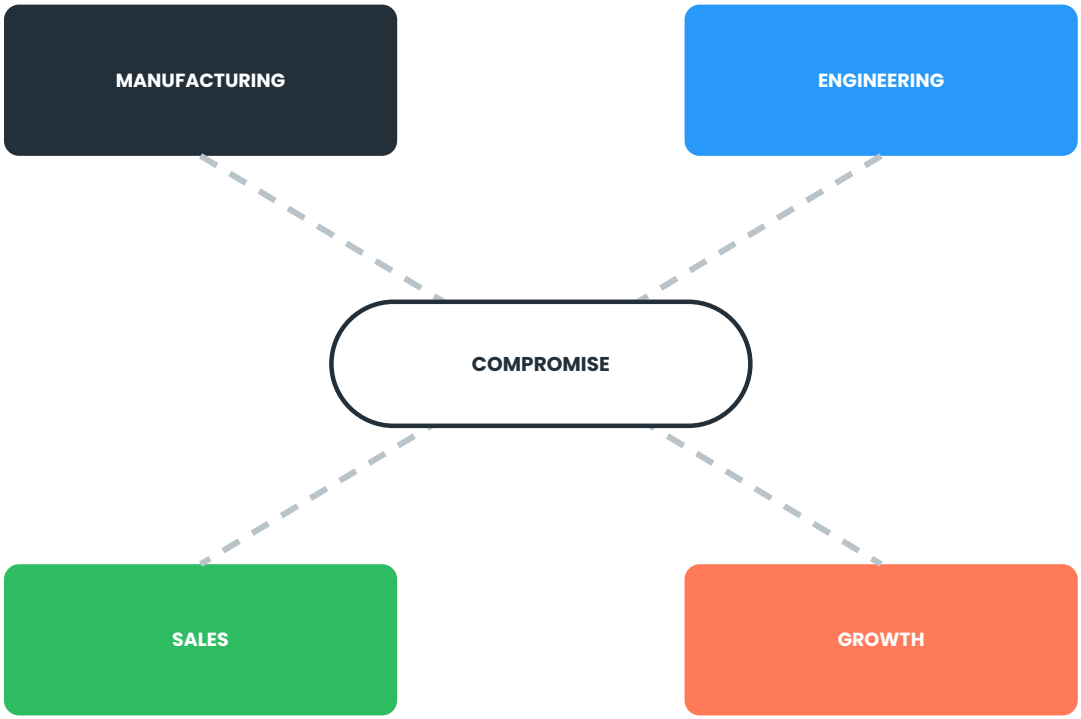
That grid is a real, current SWOT for Loopital, not an example. Notice that the weaknesses are specific enough to be uncomfortable. A SWOT where the weaknesses box says "we could improve communication" is a SWOT that was not done honestly.

> **The move most people miss.** The value is not in the four lists, it is in the pairs. Which strength can we point at which opportunity? Which weakness makes which threat genuinely dangerous? That second question is where the real decisions live.

The Conjoined Triangle of Success

This is a Loopital framework. Picture a square with four forces at its corners, and a diagonal running through the middle.

- **Manufacturing**, how we actually produce and ship what we build.
- **Engineering**, how well and how correctly it is built.
- **Sales**, our ability to get it in front of the people who need it.
- **Growth**, our ability to make that reach compound rather than repeat.
- **Compromise**, the diagonal, because these forces genuinely pull against each other.



The diagonal exists because perfect engineering, pushed too far, slows growth. Fast growth, chased carelessly, breaks what engineering built. Manufacturing capacity constrains what sales can promise. Every real decision sits somewhere along one of these tensions.

> **How to use it in an actual argument.** When a decision feels stuck, name which two corners are in tension, then name the compromise out loud. "We are trading engineering quality for speed to hit this pilot date, and we will pay it back in the following sprint" is a decision. "Let us just ship it" is an accident waiting to be discovered later.

Success is not choosing a corner. It is knowing which compromise you are making, choosing it deliberately, and saying so.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

Everyone Is in Marketing and Sales

This is not a motivational slogan. In a ten person company, it is a structural fact. Every person here will, at some point, be the entire company in someone's eyes.

The moment you tell someone what Loopital does, you are marketing. The moment a hospital administrator forms an impression from how you handled a meeting, that is sales. When an engineer answers a customer's question clearly, that is customer success. None of these are departments you can wait for.

The three sentence version everyone should know

You should be able to explain Loopital to a stranger without notes. Here is the version to internalise, then say in your own words.

> **"We build software for hospitals, schools, and businesses in Nigeria. Our main product gives patients one health record that follows them to any hospital, so nobody has to explain their medical history from memory in an emergency. We are early stage, one product is live with real clients and the rest are moving into pilots now."**

Notice the third sentence. Including our actual stage is not weakness, it is what makes the first two believable. People trust specific, bounded claims far more than sweeping ones.

How to talk about what is not finished yet

You will regularly be asked about products still in testing. There is a correct way to answer.

- **Say:** "It is built and we are testing it internally before our first hospital pilots."
- **Do not say:** "It is launching soon" if no date exists, or "we have users" if we do not.
- **If you do not know:** say you will find out and come back. Then actually come back. That single behaviour builds more trust than any answer you could have improvised.

> **Why this matters more for us than most companies.** We are asking hospitals to trust us with patient information. Trust is our actual product. One overstatement that gets discovered costs more than any deal it might have won, because it reframes everything else we have said as possibly untrue.

Do things that do not scale, applied here

Chapter 8 covered Paul Graham's principle and the Airbnb founders photographing apartments themselves. Our version: at this stage, we onboard hospitals personally, we sit with staff while they use HMS7 for the first time, and we answer support questions directly rather than through a ticket system.

This is not inefficiency. It is the fastest available way to learn what our product actually needs, and it is only possible while we are small. Use the window.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN

Customers: How We Earn and Keep Them

Our growth strategy depends almost entirely on people recommending us to other people. That makes how we treat each individual customer a growth strategy, not a courtesy.

Why we start free

We offer free pilots to hospitals rather than leading with price. Three reasons, all practical.

- It removes the largest objection at the moment trust is thinnest. A hospital administrator risking budget on an unproven young company has to justify it. Risking nothing but time is a much smaller decision.
- It forces us to prove value before we can charge for it, which is the proof before scale value from Chapter 1 made operational.
- It produces the evidence that makes every subsequent conversation easier, with the next hospital, with a ministry, with an investor.

The referral engine

Institutional buyers, particularly in healthcare, move on peer recommendation far more than advertising. A hospital administrator asking another administrator whether something works is worth more than any campaign we could run.

This means every pilot has a second purpose beyond the customer themselves. It is producing a reference. Treat every interaction accordingly, especially the unglamorous ones. The support request handled well at an awkward hour is frequently what gets mentioned when someone asks about us.

> **The specific ask that works.** After a pilot produces a real result, do not say "let us know if you hear of anyone." Ask a specific question: "Who else do you know running a facility like this who deals with the same problem?" Specific questions get specific answers. Vague ones get politeness.

When something goes wrong

It will. A system will go down, a feature will behave unexpectedly, someone will be let down. What separates companies is entirely what happens next.

- **Tell them before they tell you**, whenever possible. Discovering a problem yourself and reporting it builds trust. Being caught by the customer destroys it.
- **Say what happened plainly**, without hiding behind technical language they cannot evaluate.
- **Say what you are doing about it, and by when.** Then meet that time, or tell them before it passes that you will not.
- **Repair fully.** Tetrism forgives the decision, not the consequence. Fixing our own mistakes at our own cost is not generosity, it is obligation.

> **The standard to hold.** A customer who had a problem that we handled honestly and quickly often becomes more loyal than one who never had a problem at all. That is not a reason to cause problems. It is a reason to treat the ones that happen as the opportunity they genuinely are.

PART FIVE

How We Treat Each Other

A ten person company has nowhere to hide a bad relationship. How we handle disagreement, feedback, rest, and basic professional conduct determines whether this is a place people do their best work or simply survive.

16 Culture, Feedback, and Disagreement

17 Work, Rest, Play, and Not Burning Out

18 Professional Conduct, In Person and Online

CHAPTER SIXTEEN

Culture, Feedback, and Disagreement

Culture is not what a company says it values. It is the behaviour that actually gets rewarded, tolerated, and punished. This chapter describes what we intend to reward.

Psychological safety is the foundation

Google spent years studying what made some of its teams far more effective than others, in a research effort called Project Aristotle. The finding surprised them. It was not individual talent, seniority, or team composition. The strongest predictor was psychological safety, the shared belief that you can take an interpersonal risk, admit a mistake, ask a basic question, or disagree with a senior person, without being punished or humiliated.

This is not a soft concern for us. We handle health data. A team where people quietly hide errors because admitting them feels dangerous is a team that will eventually hurt a patient. Safety to speak is a safety control.

> **What this asks of you specifically.** When someone admits a mistake, your first response sets the culture more than any policy does. Thank them for raising it, then move to the fix. If people learn that admitting things costs them, they will stop, and you will lose the ability to see problems while they are still small.

How we give feedback

Kim Scott, who worked at both Google and Apple, described a useful frame called radical candor: caring personally about someone while challenging them directly. She contrasts it with three failures, ruinous empathy, where you care but will not say the hard thing, obnoxious aggression, where you challenge without care, and manipulative insincerity, which is neither.

Most people at small companies fail toward ruinous empathy. They avoid the difficult conversation to preserve the relationship, and the person keeps making the same mistake for months.

- **Be specific.** "The report was confusing" is not usable. "The summary came after three pages of detail, so the reader had to work to find the point" is.
- **Be timely.** Feedback delivered weeks later is a complaint. Delivered same day, it is help.
- **Address the work, not the person.** "This approach has a problem" lands very differently from "you are careless."
- **Ask for it yourself, regularly.** A team where only senior people give feedback is not a feedback culture, it is a review process.

Disagree and commit

This principle is used at Amazon and elsewhere, and it solves a specific problem: teams that either avoid disagreement entirely, or disagree forever without deciding.

The rule is that disagreement is expected and welcome before a decision, argued openly and hard. Once the decision is made, everyone commits fully, including the people who argued against it. You do not undermine it quietly, relitigate it in side conversations, or execute it half heartedly to prove you were right.

> **The commitment part is the hard part.** If you argued against something and it is failing, the correct move is not "I said so." It is to bring the new evidence to the person who decided, honestly, so the decision can be revisited on its merits. That is Tetrism in practice, judge the placement by what was knowable, then revise as better information arrives.

Assume good intent, then verify

In a small team under pressure, messages get short and tone gets lost. Someone will read a two word reply as dismissiveness that was actually just haste.

The working rule is to assume the most reasonable interpretation first, then check directly if it still bothers you. "Did you mean X by that?" resolves in thirty seconds what a week of quiet resentment cannot.

Credit and blame

- **Credit is given specifically and publicly.** "The onboarding went well" is worth less than "the onboarding went well because of how the setup guide was written."
- **Blame is discussed privately and focuses on the system.** When something fails, the useful question is what made the failure possible, not who to attach it to.
- **Nobody takes credit for someone else's work.** This is the one thing on this page that is not a preference. It is a firing offence in most serious companies, and it should be.

Ubuntu, applied to a working week

From Chapter 9: a person is a person through other people. In practice this means finishing your task and then asking who is blocked, rather than immediately starting the next thing. It means celebrating a teammate's win genuinely rather than measuring it against your own.

In a company this size, another person's success is not competition. There is more work than people, and the constraint on all of us is the same: whether this company survives long enough to matter.

CHAPTER SEVENTEEN

Work, Rest, Play, and Not Burning Out

Startup culture has a romanticised relationship with overwork that has produced a great deal of damage and remarkably little evidence of benefit. We want the intensity without the wreckage.

Honest about the demands

Early stage company work is genuinely demanding. There will be periods before a pilot launch or a funding deadline that require more than a standard week. Pretending otherwise would be dishonest, and honesty is one of our six values.

What we reject is the idea that this should be permanent, or that exhaustion is evidence of commitment. Sustained overwork produces worse decisions, more defects, and higher turnover. In a company handling health data, tired people making mistakes is not a productivity issue, it is a safety issue.

> **The distinction we hold.** Intensity in bursts, around real deadlines, chosen deliberately, is part of this work. Permanent overload with no recovery is not intensity, it is a management failure, and it should be raised as one.

Recognising burnout in yourself and others

Burnout does not usually announce itself. It shows up as cynicism about work that used to matter, difficulty starting tasks that used to be easy, exhaustion that a weekend does not fix, and a quiet withdrawal from the team.

If you notice this in yourself, say so early. If you notice it in a teammate, ask them directly and privately. The cost of asking and being wrong is a slightly awkward conversation. The cost of not asking is losing someone good.

Play, and why it is in this handbook

Tetris is our company game, for the philosophical reason in Chapter 10 and because it is genuinely enjoyable. We mean for it to actually be played, together, not just referenced.

Beyond that, we encourage real disconnection. Games, sport, time outdoors, whatever properly stops the work loop in your head. Teams that only ever discuss work think in progressively narrower circles. Some of the most useful ideas this company has had arrived when nobody was trying.

Practical expectations

- Take your rest days. A team that never stops is a team that stops all at once, later, involuntarily.
- Messages outside working hours do not require an immediate answer unless genuinely urgent, and genuinely urgent should be rare.
- If you are ill, do not work. This is not heroism, and in a small team, spreading illness is expensive.
- If work is affecting your health, say so. That conversation is always available and it is never held against you.

CHAPTER EIGHTEEN

Professional Conduct

Small habits, applied consistently, are what make a young company feel credible to a hospital administrator who is deciding whether to trust us.

In person and in shared spaces

- **Be on time, and communicate lateness before the time,** not after. A message at five minutes before is courtesy. A message ten minutes after is an apology.
- **Dress appropriately for who you will encounter.** Meeting a hospital's medical director is not the same as a working day at your desk. When in doubt, slightly more formal.
- **Keep shared spaces usable for the next person.** Clean, organised, cables managed.
- **Respect focus.** Before interrupting someone visibly deep in work, ask whether now is a good time.

In online meetings

- **Join on time, camera on by default.** Presence matters through a screen, especially with external partners. If there is a reason your camera is off, say so briefly rather than leaving people talking to a black square.
- **Mute when not speaking**, particularly in larger calls.
- **Come prepared.** If an agenda or document was shared, read it beforehand. Using meeting time to read what could have been read alone is the most common way small companies waste their scarcest resource.
- **One conversation at a time.** Do not hold a side chat in the messages while someone is presenting.
- **End with clarity.** Who is doing what, by when. A meeting that ends without that has usually not finished.

In writing

- **Lead with the point.** Context after. People reading on a phone between tasks should get the substance in the first sentence.
- **Re read before sending.** Tone is lost easily in text, and a message that reads as curt to you reads as hostile to someone having a difficult day.
- **Respond within a reasonable window during working hours,** even if only to say you will answer properly later. Silence creates more uncertainty in a small team than almost anything else.
- **Write as though it could be forwarded,** because it can be. This is not about caution, it is about not writing anything you would need to explain later.

Representing Loopital externally

When you are in a hospital, at an event, or in a partner meeting, you are the company. Everything in Chapter 14 about how we describe ourselves applies, particularly the honesty about our stage. If you are unsure whether something is ours to share publicly, ask first. Information about a customer, a partner conversation, or an internal decision is not yours to distribute by default.

PART SIX

Our Responsibilities

We handle information that can affect someone's medical treatment. That places obligations on us that most software companies do not carry. This final part covers those obligations, and how to begin well.

19 Safety: Operational, Physical, and Cyber

20 Your First 90 Days, and Beyond

CHAPTER NINETEEN

Safety

For most software companies, a security incident is embarrassing and expensive. For us, it can mean a hospital cannot see a patient's allergies. Read this chapter as operational, not administrative.

Operational safety

- **Follow documented processes for handling health data.** If a process is unclear, ask before improvising. Improvised handling of patient information is how serious breaches begin.
- **Access only what your work requires.** Curiosity about a record you have no reason to open is not a small thing in health data. It is the exact behaviour data protection law exists to prevent.
- **Test before shipping, always.** Especially anything touching prescriptions, patient identity, or emergency features.
- **Report near misses, not just incidents.** A near miss is free information about a failure that has not happened yet. Under Tetrism, a fast honest report is never punished.

> **The Nigeria Data Protection Act applies to us directly.** Health data is sensitive personal data under the Act, and the penalties for mishandling it are real. More importantly, so is the harm. Treat compliance as protection for the people whose records we hold, not as paperwork.

Physical safety

- Keep workspaces clear of trip hazards, trailing cables, and clutter.
- Know where exits and fire extinguishers are in any space you work from, including client sites.
- When visiting hospitals or client premises, follow their safety rules without exception, including any infection control requirements. You are a guest in someone else's safety system.
- If you ever feel unsafe, in the office, travelling, or at a client site, say so immediately and remove yourself. No task is worth your physical safety, and nobody here will second guess that judgement.

Cyber safety

- **Strong unique passwords, and two factor authentication on every company account.** No exceptions, including accounts that feel unimportant. Attackers enter through the unimportant ones.
- **Never share credentials,** even with a teammate you trust completely. Shared logins destroy the audit trail that tells us what actually happened during an incident.
- **Treat unexpected links and attachments with suspicion,** including ones that appear to come from inside the company. Impersonating a colleague is among the most common attack methods, and it works because people are trying to be helpful.
- **Lock your screen when you step away,** particularly on client premises.
- **Report anything suspicious immediately,** before attempting to fix it yourself. Speed of reporting matters more than certainty, and a false alarm costs almost nothing.

> **The standard to hold in your head.** Every record in our systems belongs to a real person who never met us and had no say in whether to trust us. Their consent was given to their hospital. We are borrowing it. Behave accordingly.

CHAPTER TWENTY

Your First 90 Days

Nobody expects you to be useful on day one. But there is a difference between a first three months that builds a foundation and one that drifts. Here is what good looks like.

Days 1 to 30: understand before you optimise

- Read this handbook fully. Then note the three things you disagree with, and raise at least one.
- Learn what every one of our five products does and what stage each is at, well enough to explain them to a stranger without notes.
- Meet everyone. In a ten person company, there is no excuse for not knowing what each person is responsible for.
- Sit in on a customer conversation, whatever your role. Engineers especially. Watching a real user struggle with something you built is worth more than any specification.
- Ask the questions that feel too basic. Your first month is the only period where "why do we do it this way" carries no social cost. Spend it.

A note on the honeymoon period. New people see clearly what everyone else has stopped noticing. That perspective has a short shelf life, usually about six weeks, before you normalise to how things are. Write down what looks strange to you now. Some of it will be things we should genuinely fix.

Days 31 to 60: contribute and complete

- Own something end to end, however small. Completing one thing fully teaches more than participating in five.
- Make your first mistake and report it early. Genuinely. People who have never made a visible mistake in a startup are usually not taking enough initiative.
- Give feedback to someone more senior than you. This is a test of whether the culture in Chapter 16 is real, and it only becomes real when people use it.
- Find one process that could be better and improve it. Kaizen from Chapter 9 says that is yours to do without permission.

Days 61 to 90: take real ownership

- Take responsibility for an area, not just tasks within one. The difference is whether someone has to remind you about it.
- Bring a proposal, not just a problem. Chapter 5 gives you the language: name the failure mode it protects against, and what would tell us early if it is not working.
- Help onboard whoever joins after you. The fastest way to consolidate what you have learned is to teach it.
- Re read this handbook. It will read differently now, and that is the entire reason we asked you to read it more than once.

What we are actually looking for by day 90. Not mastery. Judgement. Someone who can face a situation this handbook does not specifically cover and make a call we would recognise as ours, then explain their reasoning honestly, including where they were unsure.

IN CLOSING

The whole point of Reach Beyond

Everything in this handbook exists for one reason. We are trying to build tools that let people reach further than the systems around them would otherwise allow. A patient who does not have to explain their history from a hospital bed. A teacher who gets their afternoon back. A business owner who stops losing track of their own work.

We believe the only honest way to build that is to work the same way internally. To be truthful about our stage. To judge decisions by what was knowable. To prove things before we claim them. To treat the people beside us as the reason any of it is possible.

You are not an employee of a finished company. You are one of the people deciding what this becomes. That is a genuinely rare position, and it does not last long. Use it.

Read this again in three months. You will have earned a different understanding of it by then.

LOOPITAL LIMITED · REACH BEYOND

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